How to Be a Villain

By Neil Zawacki

INTRODUCTION

Dracula. Hannibal. Frankenstein, the doctor or the monster, either applies -- Fictional villains are so famous all you need to hear are their names, and you know exactly who they are. Villains are some of the most memorable characters in fiction. But just how do these super villains get launched into infamy? It's How to Be a Villain, a step-by-step guide by Neil Zawacki, that answers all the most urgent questions from choosing an evil name, to marketing your brand; finding the perfect evil hideout, to developing an evil masterplan. It's cheaper than attending the annual bad guy conference and way more fun than being good. How to Be a Villain is guaranteed to elicit deep-throated evil laughs across the land! (evil laughter)

Step 1: Choosing an Evil Name (Pg 14-16)

To get your career launched with flair you'll want a good evil name for yourself. One that is memorable, pithy and short. Choose carefully because this is what the world will know you as throughout time!

The Normal Name: Believe it or not, you don't always need a big flash name. Trust in your evil deeds, and, should you become terrible enough, that alone can be enough to inspire fear in all humanity. . . *[Updated from Bill Gates and Pat Robertson, you may insert your own real-life villains]* Rudy Giuliani, OJ Simpson, Elon Musk.

[Or] The Descriptive Name: What makes you so bad? If you like to crush things, for example you might decide to call yourself The Pulverizer. Evil geniuses with multiple limbs might opt for The Octopus.

[Or perhaps a more] Sinister Name: Lord FireHammer; Duke IronSkull; Doctor WormBlight

Let your creativity blossom!

Step 2: Evil Branding (Pg 17)

Make your new designation echo in the minds of the timid for eons with some sophisticated evil branding. You won't need to consult Madison Avenue; chances are, you can come up with

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great ideas on your own. [You'll need a]

SLOGAN – Three to five words that sum up your evil ways in an intimidating fashion. Remember, you're talking directly to your victims, so make your message something they can relate to, such as, "Mercy is Not an Option!" *[add additional examples such as "You Can't Handle the Truth!" "You underestimate the power of the Dark Side!]*

[And don't forget a] **TRADEMARK GESTURE** -- Whether you leave behind a token of your villainy or howl from a mountaintop each fortnight, consistent delivery of a gesture or symbolic act, in other words a trademark, will help reinforce your name and identity, making it that much more likely that your evil ways will survive in perpetuity. *[Insert a variety of gestures, body stances, entrances/exits here; be creative]*

[Next] **THE EVIL LAUGH** – A Must-Have **(Pg 23)**

There are a number of excellent ways to enhance your evil persona, from *(in a heavy accent)* feigning a foreign accent to *(assume a physical tick)* exaggerating a physical defect or tick. However, the most essential skill by far is an evil laugh.

The evil laugh is a defining characteristic of any supervillain, and you will find yourself calling on it quite regularly as you exult in your own wickedness.

Ha Ha Ha

Hehe-he-he-he

Muahahahaha

Bwah-ha-ha-ha-ha!!!

HAHAHAHAHAHAHAHAHAHAHAHA

Once you have decided upon a laugh, practice it every day. *(laugh)* Take a deep breath, relax, and feel yourself laugh like a crazed hyena. *(laugh)* Learn all its different chortles and inflections, exploring the many ways it can inspire fear. *(laugh)*

[And finally] **FASHION FOR THE EVIL-DOER (Pg 122)**

The most agonizing decision of your evil career. What to wear? It may seem wrong, but many people will form ideas about how evil you are based on how you dress and carry yourself.

1. It's hard to go wrong with classic black. Sinister, foreboding, fashionable yet fearsome,

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black creates an air of mystery. *(trademark gesture)* Classic black remains THE fashion statement for villains everywhere.

2. **(Pg 125)** [But] If you spent your childhood hiding in the backyard reading comic books, you probably won't be happy with anything less than the supervillain costume with gimmicks. Be it a green jumpsuit with question marks or an outlandish clown suit that shoots confetti, the gimmicky costume will automatically provide a motif from which you can adopt a personal theme. As you design your costume, take your body type into consideration. Colorful leotards may be high on visual impact, but remember, spandex is a privilege, not a right!
3. **(Pg 131)** Evil masterminds who posses a magical inclination may want to invest their money in wizard's robes. These sleek garments are ideal for sorcerers providing fashion sensibility and open-air comfort. And they look great with sandals or basic black supervillain boot-socks. You can find them in a wide range of colors, including black and red – avoid white [though] both because of the association with good and because you will look like you're wearing a toga.

Step 3: [Don't forget a] **Location for Your Lair (Pg 88)**

Every evil mastermind needs a base of operations. Choose your lair carefully. If you have enemies, they will probably show up on your doorstep eventually, so you'll want it to be an impressive edifice to your grandeur. Consider . . .

1. **(Pg 90)** An Underground Secret Headquarters of Doom. *(trademark gesture)* To the untrained eye the secret entrance looks like nothing more than an isolated shack in the middle of nowhere. But should you take the secret elevator hidden within, all is horribly revealed. An underground headquarters is a diabolical lair of which you can be proud. Popular for their low energy bills, privacy and "only a madman could live here" ambience, *(laugh)* a subterranean lair is an excellent choice indeed.
2. **(Pg 92)** The Fake Mountain with a hollow interior is another appealing site. On the outside it looks like any other mountain, but with the flip of a switch you can transform it into a deadly fortress of doom! *(laugh)* The only caveat with the fake mountain is that

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you should not place it in the middle of a city. For some reason, they are too often noticed there.

3. **(Pg 93)** Although considered gimmicky for years, the amusement park lair has seen a resurgence in popularity in recent times. The reason is simple: The décor can easily be transformed into a carnival of horrors, the fun houses laced with booby traps and the hall of mirrors at the end for confronting the heroes. The tunnel of love offers endless possibilities for becoming the tunnel of screams *(scream turning into laughter)* Fun for the whole family!

Step 4: [And Last but Not Least . . . You must have an **Evil Plan**]

(Pg 140) Have you ever wanted to make a great evil plan, but didn't have the time? You're not alone. In fact, many evil men and women struggle with this culminating act. The secret to success is planning ahead. The Evil Plan Generator will help you! By identifying your goals, means and target for destruction, the EPG lets you concoct a truly nefarious scheme in a matter of minutes. Simply fill in the blanks! *(See fill-in-the-blank options at the end of the selection)*

(Pg 156) STAGE 1: To begin, you must first **(ACTION) (TARGET).** This will cause the world to **(REACTION), (DESCRIPTIVE VERB)** by your arrival. Who is this **(NAME)**? Where did they come from? And why do they look so good in **(FASHION)**?

STAGE 2: Next, you must **(ACTION) (MONUMENT).** This will all be done from your **(BASE),** a mysterious place of unrivaled dark glory. Upon seeing this, the world will **(REACTION),** as countless hordes of **(HENCHMEN)** hasten to do your every bidding.

STAGE 3: Finally, you must **(ACTION)** your **(WEAPON),** bringing about **(DESTINY).** Your name shall become synonymous with **(RANDOM),** and no man will ever again dare **(TRAGIC PAST).** Everyone will bow before your **(POWER),** and the world will have no choice but to **(END RESULT).**

SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

2008 National Qualifier
2009 National Qualifier
2022 National Qualifier – MS
2023 National Qualifier – MS
2024 National Qualifier – MS
KS State Qualifier
OH State Qualifier

(Pg 142-153) STAGE 1: Fill-in-the-blank Options

ACTION:	TARGET:	REACTION:
Kidnap	A Police Chief	Sit up and take notice
Clone	A Wealthy Heiress	Swallow nervously
Devour	A Military General	Choke on their food
Blackmail	Superman	Whisper among themselves
Incapacitate	A Wizard's Apprentice	Sense a grave disturbance in the force
Seduce	A Town Mascot	Sign up for life insurance policies
Expose	A Rock Star	Leave the country
Incinerate	The President	(Other)
DESCRIPTIVE VERB:	**NAME:**	**FASHION:**
Amazed	Criminal Mastermind	Classic Black
Baffled	Evil Genius	A Business Suit
Shocked	Demented Madman	That Gigantic Silver Helmet
Terrified	Future Ruler of All Mankind	Spandex
Frightened	Destroyer of All That is Good	An Off-Center Blonde Wig
Alarmed	and Nice	A Pink Tutu
Bewildered	(Other)	(Other)
Paralyzed		

STAGE 2: Fill-in-the-blank Options

ACTION:	MONUMENT:	BASE: Location of Your Lair
Seize control of	Mount Rushmore	Medieval Castle
Disintegrate	Fort Knox	Corporate Tower
Steal	The Grand Canyon	Underground Secret Headquarters of Doom
Poison	The Pyramids of Giza	Desert Island
Smash	The Opera House in	Abandoned Warehouse
Sabotage	Sydney	Ancient Tomb

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Obliterate Vaporize (Other)	The Internet The Pacific Ocean The Moon	Space Station Amusement Park (Other)
REACTION: Scream Faint Tremble Give up Weep uncontrollably Run away Die in a way you just don't want to think about Fall into catatonic trances		**HENCHMEN:** Corporate Cronies Winged Monkeys Robot Warriors Ninjas Ailen Life Forms Demented Clowns English Teachers Zombies

STAGE 3: Fill-in-the-blank Options

ACTION: Reveal to the world Unleash Covertly move Release Send forth Let Loose Tauntingly wave Activate (Other)	**WEAPON:** Corporate Takeover Armies of Destruction Doomsday Device Secret Death Ray Needlessly Big Weather Machine Blow Up Clown Hammer Super Loud Rock Music (Other)	**DESTINY:** Pain, suffering, the usual Something really, really bad The return of Conway Twitty Global Climate Change The end of chocolate cake The demise of the Internet The return of Covid-19 restrictions (Other)
RANDOM: Fuzzy bunnies Shenanigans Skullduggery Mealworms Dry Heaves Eating Brussel Sprouts (Other)	**TRAGIC PAST:** Beat you up Call you names Roll his/her eyes Interrupt you Tak your lunch money Refuse to be your prom date (Other)	**POWER:** Supreme Might Cunning Intelligence Dashing Good Looks Superior Nasal Power Unmatched Physical Prowess X-Ray Vision Power of Invisibility
END RESULT: Elect you ruler for life Give you control of the planet Send you all their money Name you Man/Woman of the Year Erect a gigantic statue of you Restore your credit rating (Other)		

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